Institute of Public Administration

IPA
INSTITUTE OF PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION
AN FORAS RIARACHÁIN

2025/2026 Certificate in Local Government Studies Exam Prep Presentation

Accredited by NUI

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EFQM IN PARTNERSHIP WITH EIQA RECOGNITION OF EXCELLENCE

Content

AREA 1 Introduction to MCQ exam

AREA 2 Summary of Chapters

AREA 3 Sample Questions

Introduction to MCQ Exam

- Former director of the Education Division in IPA and former Director of the Local Govt division IPA and former Cert and Dip Programme Director
- Ist time - MCQ
- I hr on line exam using moodle
- 40 questions
- One answer per question a, b, c, d
- Same 40 questions for all students but students will get different bank of questions
- Sample questions on Moodle
- Questions based on Cert Notes

Chapter 1 : Rationale, Governance and Development of LG

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Rationale and Governance

- Framework of Govt in Ireland
- LG : Principal Agent Relationship – Governance
- CS : Fund ; Policy; write Legislation
- LG : Implement Policy and Legislation
- Legislature: Oireachtas implements the law
- Const: Art 28 A – Subsidiarity 1999
- EU and LG: Funding; Policy; Legislation
- Rationale: democratic Forum; Deliver Services: Regulation; Enforcement; Granting:
- Code of Governance : 2015; 2024 : 6 Principles

Chapter 1 : Rationale, Governance and Development of LG Cont'd

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Development of LG: Landmarks in LG History

- 1898 Act
- Some TC s preceded 1898
- County Management Act 1940
- Health Act 1970
- 2001 LG Reform
- 2014 LG Reform Act
- Today 31 LAs; Pre 2014 114 LAs; TC s abolished and Merged LAs
- Today 949 Ems and 1 DEM; Pre 2014 1627 EMS

Quick Overview of the Development of the LG system Cont'd : 8 service Divisions over 1,000 services

Housing

Roads, transportation & safety

Water supply and Sewerage (Water Services)

Planning

Environmental protection & waste management

Recreation & amenities

Agriculture, education, health & welfare

Miscellaneous

Chapter 2: reform

- Big desire to reform from Late 1990s
- BLG 1996
- 2001 Local Government Reform Act

- Major Reform Areas: NPF
  - Corporate Plans, Business Plans
  - Major Staffing Structural Change
  - PMDS
  - Bonus System for key staff
  - AFSs and Accrual Accounting
  - KPIs
  - SPCs
  - CPGs
  - CDBs Replaced by LCDCs ;
  - Local Govt Fund – Revenue Financing

Chapter 2: reform

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- **Key Reports that influenced the 2nd wave of Reform**
  - **Indecon Report 2004**
  - **OECD 2008**
  - **Mc Carthy (An Bord Snip Nua) 2009**
  - **Mc Loughlin ; LGER (An Bord Snip Eile) 2010**
- **Putting People First (PPF) 2012**
- **Local Government Reform Act 2014**
- **Reform came in after 2014 Local Elections**
- **2024 DEM Local Govern Mayor of Limerick Act**

Chapter 2: reform

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2nd Wave of Reform and the LG Reform Act 2014 based on PPF

- **Streamlining LG** (Abolish 80 TCs ; replace MDs parts 2- 4 Act); Abolish 8 RA s and 2 RA; replace 3 RAs; part 10 Act)
- New **Role for LG in Economic Devel and Enterprise** (Abolish CDBs; replace LCDCs; part 6 Act); Abolish CEBs; replace LEOs; part 6 Act); New SPC for Econ Dev and Enterprise
- New **Financing model (**LPT); part 8 Act
- New **Governance Structures** ; Part 7-8 Act: NOAC
- Terms: SPC; CPG; ETBs; LEOs; PPN; MDS; NOAC; LPT; LCDC; LECPs; BLG; PPF

Chapter 3 Finance

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Rev Exp

- 8 Service Divisions
- Sources of Funding Rev Exp: Commercial Rates; Services Charges; LPT; Grants and Subsidies
- Revenue Budget : Balanced Budget : GARV: Role of Tailte Eireann
- Reserved function – Balanced Budget
- Steps involved in budgetary process

Chapter 3 Finance Cont'd

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Capital Exp

- Sources of Funding : Central Grants: Dev Levies; Sale of Assets; Borrowing; Transfers from Rev; EU
- 3 Year Capital Forecast : S135 Report

Audit

- Local Government Auditor: AFS; VFM reports
- Internal Audit
- Audit Committee : 7 person or 5 Person: 2014 LG Act
- Terms : LGAS; GMA;ARV;VFM;NOAC;BID

Chapter 4: HRM

- 2001 LG Act Ethics Framework
- Recruitment and Selection
- Staff training and Development
- PMDS: PDPs; TDPs; Service Delivery Plans; Corporate Plan
- NOAC : 43 KPIs
- Equality, Disability, work life balance
- Dignity at work; Parttime-Full Time employees; Family friendly policies; work sharing etc
- Industrial Relations: WRC; Labour Court
- Safety Health and Welfare at Work : 2005 Act: HSA
- LGMA:
- PAS

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Role of CE in LG

1. Lead the LA/organisation in a **dynamic environment**;
2. Responsible for day-to-day **admin & financial** business;
3. **Implementation** of policies;
4. Maximise social, economic & physical **development**;
5. **Advise & assist** Elected Council

Chapter 5: Role of CE; Ems & Procedures at council meetings Cont'd

Role of Elected Members in LG

1. Elected Council > crucial **part of democratic system**
2. **Representative** role
3. **Policy-making** arm of the LA
4. Local **watchdog**/ombudsman
5. Carry-out **Reserved Functions**
6. Reserved Functions **mainly on policy & finance:** Egs > Adoption of corporate plan; disposal of land; making of CDP; adopt annual budgets; vary LPT; conferral of civic honours; create bye-laws.

Chapter 5: Role of CE; Ems & Procedures at council meetings Cont'd

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- Committees of LAs: SPCs; CPGs; Area Committee; Audit Committees; JPCs/Local Community Safety Partnerships

- Meeting: Annual Meeting; Budget Meeting; Monthly Meetings; MD meeting; Quorums; Notices of Motions; Minutes; Meetings Administrator; Standing Orders;

- Terms; Chairperson/Mayor/ Cathoirleach; Vice Chairperson/Deputy Mayor/Leas Cathaiorleach/ Priomh Chomhairleach; S140 Motions; Agendas; Public Notice: Reserved v Executive Functions: RFs Schedule 3 2014 Act

Chapter 6 Planning and Development

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- 6 Year Development Plan – 2000 P and d Act as amended
- Mandatory objectives of DP : S10 2000 Act ; S 7 2010 Act
- Making of Development Plan
- Core Strategy – 2010 P and D Act
- Material Contraventions
- Variation of the DP – OPR
- National ; Regional Policy
- Planning Permission – 4 types of planning applications
- Planning application process : Public Notice; Time duration; Maps etc

Chapter 6 Planning and Development Cont'd

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- Exempted development: S 5 developments
- LA developments : S179 2000 P and D act; S 4 2024 P and D act; Part 8 2001 Regs
- Planning Appeals and Coimisiun Pleanala
- The planning appeal process; 3rd Party appeal
- Planning Enforcement – Unauthorised Development : warning letter; Enforcement notices; S160 Injunctions
- Planning and Housing: Housing Strategy: Part V
- Strategic Development: SDZ – 2000 Act; UDZ – 2024 Act; SIDs -2006 Act
-

Chapter 6 Planning and Development Cont'd

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- SEA/ SEA report – SEA Directive
- Habitats – NIR report – Habitats Directive
- Land acquisition powers of LAs : CPOs – 2001 Act ; 2024 Act
- Building Control – Building Control Act 1990
- Planning Register
- Architectural Heritage; ACAs; Protected Structures
- Terms; SPAs; SACs; NHAs; RSES; OPR; EIA;RPS

Chapter 7 Housing and Building

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- Agencies: DHLGH; HA; LDA; AHBs; AHBRA; ICSH; LAs
- Social Housing Supply: LAs; RAS/RS; HAP; AHBs
- Exchequer Funding: SHIP;CALF;CAS;CLASS;SHCEP
- Affordable Housing : 2021 Affordable Housing Act; PART V; LAAHP Scheme ; Cost Rental

Chapter 7 Housing and Building Cont'd

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Functions of LAs

- Assessment of Needs – 2009 Act 2011 Regs as amended
- Housing Allocation Scheme : CBL – 2009 Act 2011 Regs
- Housing Rents – 1966 Act
- Regeneration
- Incremental Tenant Purchase Scheme – 2014 Act
- Housing Loans; 2012 Affordable Housing Act

Chapter 7 Housing and Building Cont'd

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Functions of LAs

- HAGs – 3 Types
- Homelessness – 1988 Housing Act
- Housing First
- Rental inspections – 2017 Regs
- RTB
- Traveller Accommodation - 1998 Act
- Estate Management /ASB – 1992; 1997;2009;2014 Acts ASB Strategy
- Housing Policy- 2021 Housing for All; 2025; Delivering Homes Building Communities 2025-2030

Chapter 8: Climate Change

Context to Ireland's Commitment to tackling Climate Change

- 1992 UNFCCC (Rio)
- 1997 UN Kyoto Protocol came into effect in 2005
- National Climate Change Strategies 2000-2007, 2007-2013
- 2005 Complying with the EU ETS Directive
- 2015 UN Paris Agreement
- 2015 Climate Action Act as amended in 2021
- 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023,2024, 2025 Climate Action Plans State Bodies
- 2019-2024 and 2024-2029 LA Climate Action Plans

Chapter 8: Climate Change Cont'd

1. Atlantic Seaboard North CARO
2. Eastern and Midlands CARO
3. Dublin Metropolitan Caro
4. Atlantic Seaboard South CARO

Chapter 8: Climate Change Cont'd

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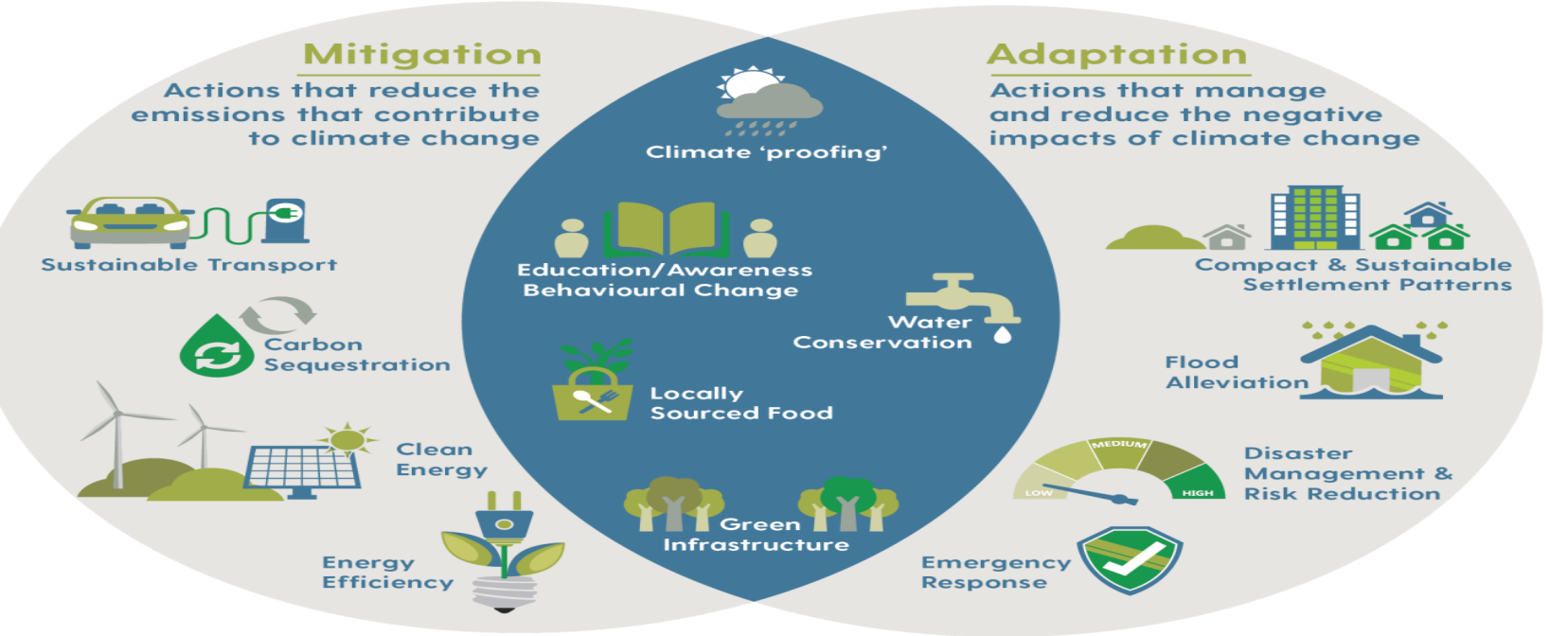
- First Round: 2019-2024
- Second Round: 2024-2029

Targets Set out in the Plan

- Energy Efficiency : 50% improvement in Energy Efficiency by 2030
- Resilience: X climate resilient region by reducing future climate
- GHG: 51% Reduction in greenhouse gases by 2030
- Awareness: Actively engaging& informing citizens/communities/Businesses in X
- CO2: Net zero CO 2 by 2050

Chapter 8: Climate Change Cont'd



Climate Change Mitigation
Relates to changing how we live, move, consume and manufacture, so as to reduce and/or eliminate the production of harmful greenhouse gases; it also includes how we best use our land.

Climate Change Adaptation
Refers to dealing with the impacts of climate change and involves taking practical actions to manage risks, protect communities and strengthen the resilience of the economy (e.g., from flooding, sea level rise etc). *(Source: EPA.ie)*

Chapter 8: Climate Change Cont'd

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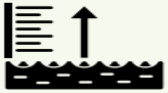
Chapter 8: Climate Change Cont'd

Impact		Exposure/Risk
Alluvial (River) Flooding		• Damage to critical infrastructure • Reduced function of transport • Increased maintenance works • Reduced water quality • Environmental contamination • Stress on biodiversity and environmentally sensitive areas • Pressure on emergency response staff over prolonged periods
Pluvial (Land/Surface) Flooding		• Damage to critical infrastructure • Reduced function of transport • Increased maintenance works • Reduced water quality • Prolonged disruption of services
Coastal Flooding		• Harm to harbour services • Damage to environmentally sensitive areas (estuaries and beaches) • Increased vulnerability of coastal communities
Extreme Precipitation		• Contaminated water bodies • Increased turbidity • Cancellation of events

Chapter 8: Climate Change Cont'd

Impact		Exposure/Risk
Heavy Snowfall		• Damage to over head power and communication lines • Roof collapse • Disruption to services • Water shortages • Impassible roads for extended periods
Severe Windstorm		• Serious property damage • Dangerous, potentially life threatening conditions • Habitat destruction
Storm Surge		• Critical Infrastructure exposed • Disrupted transportation routes • Increased clean-up, maintenance, and repair costs
Coastal Erosion		• Loss of homes, businesses and landscape • Loss of coastal habitats and heritage
Heatwave		• Health impacts such as heat stroke • Uncomfortable or dangerous working conditions • Reduced water quality • Risk of fires • Unusual pressure on recreational areas • Changes to growing season
Drought		• Inadequate water supply • Higher risk of waterborne disease • Additional emergency response call outs • Increased pressure on services and infrastructure
Above Average Surface Temperature		• Same as Drought or Heatwave with increased concerns for the ecological structure of the county • Changes in growing seasons • Changes for ecosystems.

Chapter 9: Environment

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Waste Management

- Waste Management Act 1996
- Changing Our Ways 1998
- Waste Management Act 2001
- Landfill directive – Environment Act 2011
- Refuse Collection
- PRI s; WEEE; ELV; Batteries etc
- Waste Licensing and Wate Permits
- Waste Enforcement – WERLAs -2015

Chapter 9: Environment

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Litter Management

- Litter Pollution Act 1997
- On the spot fines
- LMP – Enforcement ; education; Cleaning ; Partnerships
- Litter monitoring
- IBAL
- National Spring Clean and Tidy Towns

Chapter 9: Environment

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Water Management

- Public water Supply and waste Water UE SLA 2014 – 2022
- UE 2023-2026
- Group water Schemes and LA s Role
- NFGWS - MARWP
- SPSs
- Water Framework Directive (WFD) – RBD Plans – Local Authorities waters Programme (LAWPRO) and EPA to implemEnt WFD on a regional basis.
- UWWTD (Urban waste water treatment directive)
- Water Pollution prevention and Control – 1997 Act; 1990 Act; S16;S4 Licenses; Court action
- Nitrates Directive
- Septic Tanks Directive

Chapter 9: Environment

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Air Management

- 1987 Pollution Act
- Air Quality Standards Directive – role of EPA
- Sale and Burning of Bitumous coal – Enforcement Role – Regs
- Role of EPA; Licensing; Supervisory role in enforcing Env Law; Evidence and Guidance; Monitoring
- IPPC – EPA licensing large industrial ;EPA Act 2002 Agricultural with significant pollution potential
- OEE – EPA – Enhanced environmental compliance

Chapter 9: Environment

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Dangerous Structures and places/Derelict sites

- 1964 Sanitary Services act – Dangerous Structures
- 1990 Derelict Sites Act
- Derelict Sites register
- Acquisition of Derelict Sites – CPO
- Urban Regeneration Act 2015 – Vacant Sites Register and Vacant sites levy

Chapter 9: Environment

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Fire Service

- Fire Services Act 1981 – Stardust Tragedy
- Increased powers and responsibilities of LA s on fire matters
- Comprehensive system of fire safety and control

Civil Defence

- Air Raid Precautions Act 1939
- Civil Defence Officer (CDO) and asst CDO (Full time/part time- trained to deal with emergency situations)

Burial grounds

- Public Health (Ireland) Act 1878

Chapter 10 : Roads Transportation and Safety

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- Public Roads – 1993 Act; role of EMs
- Categories of Roads : Motor Ways; NP; NS; Regional and Local – 100,000 km
- Road Management Offices (RMOs) Cork and Donegal – Two largest road network in Ireland
- Abandoning and Extinguishing a Public Right of Way – 1993 Act
- Funding Road Construction and Maintenance Capital and Rev: TII;NTA;DOT
- Provision of Road Infrastructure – NDP 2021-2030 ; National strategic Objectives (NSOs)
- Maintenance: Feasance – doing something with a statutory role; Non-Feasance – failure to do something with a statutory role; Misfeasance – doing something negligently; Malfeasance- doing an unlawful act

Chapter 10 : Roads Transportation and Safety

- Traffic Management – Road Traffic Act 1968 : speed limits; traffic calming schemes; signing lining etc: Traffic Wardens; Gardai
- PPPs – Common Types; DB; DBO;DBF;DBOM;DBOMF : 2002 State Authorities Act; 2002 National Finance Development Act : role of TII
- NTA: 2009 NTA act: Active Travel Projects; Heavy Rail; Light Rail; Taxis
- TII Roads Act 2015 (NRA Pus RPA)– National roads and LUAS
- Road Safety: RSA Act 2006 : 4 Es

Chapter 11: Library, Arts, Social Welfare

- 2001 LG Act- Public Library functions – books/ record/archives etc : 330 local libraries
- National Library strategy: the library in place: Information, Recreation, Inspiration 2023 -2027
- Arts- Arts Council : Arts Act 2003: role of Local Govt – Arts programmes – visual arts; theatre; literature, dance, music etc
- Recreation and Amenity :Parks and open Spaces; Swimming pools; Sports Partnerships;
- Heritage: Heritage Act 195: Heritage Officers; Heritage Plans
- Education: Former HEGs : SUSI (Student Universal Support Ireland) 2012; ETBs
- Agriculture and Animals: FSAI Act 1998 : protect the health of the public from illness related to the consumption of food – Veterinary service – LA Vets
- Health and Safety :- HAS: 1989 Health and Safety At work Act amended in 2005: Employers Duties; Employees Duties; safety Statement

Chapter 12: Economic Development, Local Development; Elections

- PPF; 2014 LG Reform Act: LEOs

- LEOs (former CEBs) : Advice; Mentoring; Training; support; Grants : First Stop Shop; Micro Enterprises/Young Entrepreneurs : Now support 7,221 companies; 38 K jobs after 9 years

- Local development (Former CDBs): PPF : 2014 LG Act: LCDCs; Membership; LECP; SICAP ;LEADER

Chapter 12: Economic Development, Local Development; Elections

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- PPN: PPF/2014 LG Act
- 3 Pillars; Membership; Secretariat; SPCs; LCDC; JPCs : Collective voice; Influencing Policy
- Local elections: Register of Electors- Eligibility for election – over 18 : EU and non-EU citizens; Not Eligible- Garda; Judges; TDs; Senators; MEPs; Minsters
- Roll of the returning officer; The poll; voting; the count; quotas; Transfers of Surpluses; Completion of counts; Results; Casual Vacancies
- Election of Mayor/ Cathoirleach/Chairman
- DEM 2024 Local Government Mayor of Limerick Act

Sample Questions

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Question 1

- The 2014 Act set up a new SPC for?

a.Economic Development and Enterprise

b. Finance

c. Local Community Development

d. Social Development and Social enterprise

Answer = a

Question 2

- How many elected members are there in Ireland including the directly elected mayor?

a. 114

b. 1220

c. 949

D. 950

Answer = d

Sample Questions

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Question 3

- Which one of these reports was the catalyst for changes in the 2014 Local Government Reform Act?

a. People Before Profit

b. Putting People First

c. Rebuilding Ireland

d. Putting People and Communities first

Answer = b

Question 4

- Municipal Districts were set up to:

a. Allow Town Councillors to keep their jobs

b. Allow local decisions to be discussed at the local level

c. Allow high level decisions to be discussed at the local level

d. Allow Councillors to make strategic decisions

Answer = b

Sample Questions

Question 6

- LCDCs are comprised of which 4 pillars?

a.Local Government, State Bodies, Local Development Companies, Community and Voluntary

b. Local Government, Revenue, Department of Social Protection, Charities

c. Local Government, Local Enterprise, Environment, Community and Voluntary

d. Local Govt; Private Sector; Charities

Answer = a

Question 7

- Which body was set up to scrutinize the performance of local authorities?

a. Approved Housing Body Regulatory Body

b. National Oversight and Audit Commission (NOAC)

c. Regional Assembly

d. Housing Agency

Answer = b

Sample Questions

Question 7

- Which of these are not examples of service charges?

a. Housing Rents

b. Pay Parking Charges

c. Development Contributions

d. Fire Charges

- **Answer = c**

Question 8

- Between which dates must a statutory budget meeting take place?

a. 15th June and 30th June

b. 1st and 24th March

c. 1st and 24th November

D. 1st November and the 14th December

- **Answer =c**

Sample Questions

Question 9

- The external auditor to the 31 local authorities is attached to which of the following

a. National Oversight and Audit Commission (NOAC)

b. Local Government Audit Service (LGAS)

c. The Office of the Ombudsman

d. The Department of Finance

Answer = b

Question 10

- How many elected members must sit on a 7-member audit committee?

a. 3

b. 2

c. 4

d. 5

- **Answer = a**

Sample Questions

Question 11

- To be eligible to apply for the incremental purchase scheme a tenant has to have been in receipt of social housing for which length of time?

a. 1 year

b. 5years

c. 10 years

d.15 years

- **Answer = c**

Question 12

- Local authorities recoup which percentage of Housing Adaptation Grants from the Department of Housing, Local Government and Heritage?

a. 20%

b. 50%

c. 80%

d. 100%

- **Answer = b**

Sample Questions

Question 13

- Which body was set up to regulate the Approved Housing Body sector?

a. Irish Council for Social Housing

b. Approved Housing Bodies Regulatory Authority

c. Housing Agency

D. Cluid

answer = B.

Question 14

- HAP is operated on a Shared Services basis by which local authority

a. Laois County Council

b. Offaly County Council

c. Limerick City and County Council

d. Waterford City and County Council

Answer= c

Sample Questions

Question 15

- Which national body has a key role in relation to air management and works closely with local authorities?

a. EPA

b. IPA

c. CPA

d. HSA

Answer = a

Question 16

- Which regulations do local authorities adhere to in the area of air management?

a. Air Quality Standards Regulations

b. Air Pollution Regulations

c. Air Quality Improvement Regulations

d. Air Management Improvement regulations

Answer = a

Sample Questions

Question 17

- Local authorities have the power to produce which documents in relation to noise management?

a. Noise Action Plans

b. Noise Management Programmes

c. Anti-Noise Strategies

D Noise Pollution Programmes

Answer = A

Question 18

- What does the RSES stand for?

a. Regional Social and Environmental Strategy

b. Regional Spatial and Economic Strategy

c. Regional Social and Environmental Strategy

d. Regional Spatial and Environmental strategy

Answer = b

Sample Questions

Question 19

- Appeals in relation to planning permissions are made to which body?

a. Office of the Ombudsman

b. Office of the Planning Regulator (OPR)

c. Comisiun Peanala

d. DHLGH

Answer = c

Question 20

- Who is responsible for investigating complaints of unauthorised development?

a. OPR

b. Planning Authority

c. An Bord Pleanala

D. Gardai

Answer = b

Sample Questions

Question 21

- How many River Basin Districts are there in Ireland now?

a. 31

b. 18

c. 8

d. 1

Answer = d

Question 22

- Which of these is not a common type of PPP?

a. Design, Build and Finance

b. Design and Build

c. Design and Lease

d. Design, Build and Operate

Answer = c

Sample Questions

Question 23

- Which national body is responsible for occupational health and safety?

a. HSA

b. RSA

c. HSE

d. EPA

Answer = a

Question 24

- Which of these are not 1 of the 4 Es regarding road safety?

a. Education

b. Evolve

c. Engineering

d. Enforcement

Answer = b